CITY OF TORONTO · SHELTER AND OVERNIGHT SERVICES

Capacity grew faster than demand in 2025

The system opened 31 more programs while service-user days fell by about 6%. Average occupancy eased from 98.4% to 96.1%, and the share of nights running completely full fell by nearly ten points. Pressure is down. It is not gone.

REPORTING PERIOD
Jan 2024 to Dec 2025

RECORDS ANALYSED
100,337 program-days

UNIT OF ANALYSIS
One program, one night

AVERAGE OCCUPANCY 2025
96.1%
2.3 pts lower than 2024
2024: 98.4%

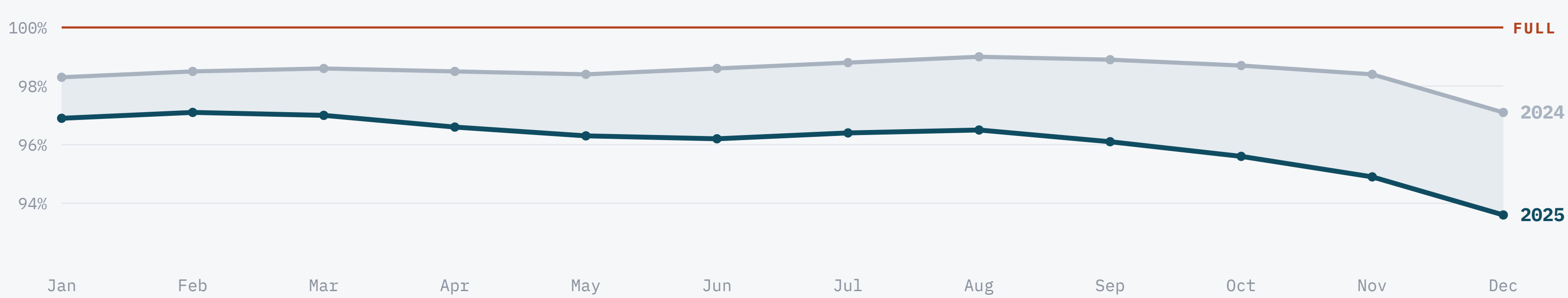
NIGHTS AT FULL CAPACITY
73.7%
9.9 pts lower than 2024
2024: 83.6% of program-days

SERVICE-USER DAYS 2025
3.36M
5.9% lower than 2024
2024: 3.57M, not unique people

PROGRAMS OPERATING 2025
188
31 more than 2024
2024: 157, over 51,543 days

The 2025 curve sits below 2024 in every month, and the gap widens after summer

Both years follow the same seasonal shape. Occupancy climbs through late summer and drops in December, when the City opens extra winter sites. The shaded gap is the easing between the two years.



Average occupancy rate by month. Axis zoomed to 92% to 101%.

WHAT THIS MEANS

Relief came from supply, not from fewer people needing a bed. Demand fell about 6%, while space grew faster.

The system still runs at 96% on average. Nine in ten program-days are full or nearly full, so there is little slack.

The spare space is uneven. Youth programs average the most room, yet their busiest sites still run at 99%.

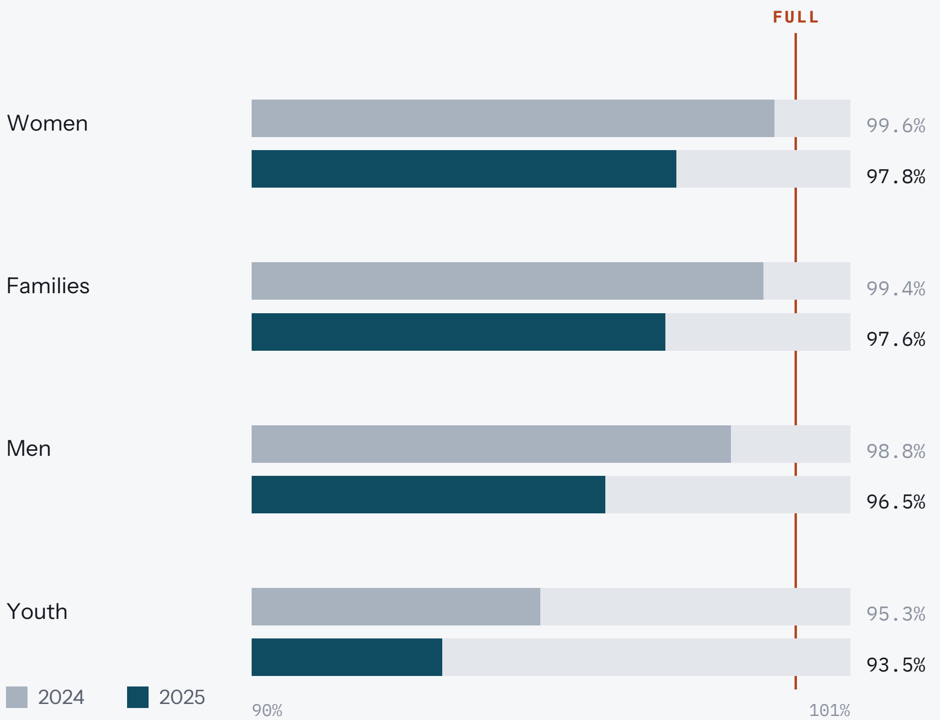
City of Toronto Open Data, Daily Shelter and Overnight Service Occupancy and Capacity. Jan 1 2024 to Dec 31 2025.
Prepared by Ryan Xian. Analysis in BigQuery SQL, report in Power BI.

Every group got more room, and the ranking did not move

Women's and family programs stayed the fullest in both years. Youth programs average the most space. Emergency shelters stayed busier than transitional ones throughout, and the gap between the two models widened.

Occupancy by population sector

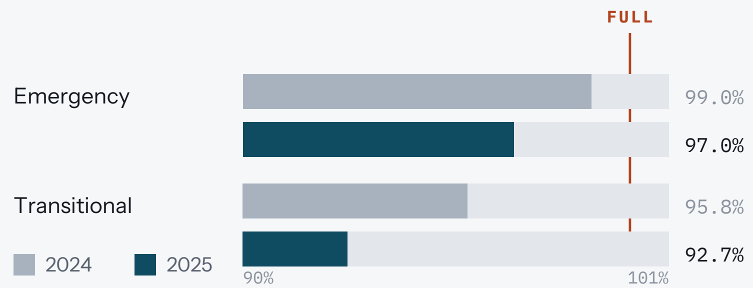
Each sector eased by 1.8 to 2.3 points. Youth was the only sector where demand rose, up about 10% in service-user days, yet it still averages the most available space.



Average occupancy rate. Axis zoomed to 90% to 101%. Mixed Adult programs are included in system totals and are not broken out here.

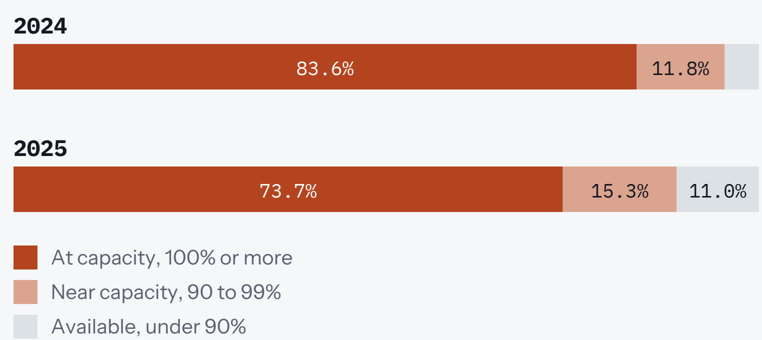
Emergency vs transitional programs

Emergency shelters ran 4.3 points fuller than transitional programs in 2025, up from a 3.2 point gap in 2024.



How often programs were full

Each bar is one year of program-days. The share with real availability more than doubled, from 4.6% to 11.0%, but nine in ten nights are still full or nearly full.



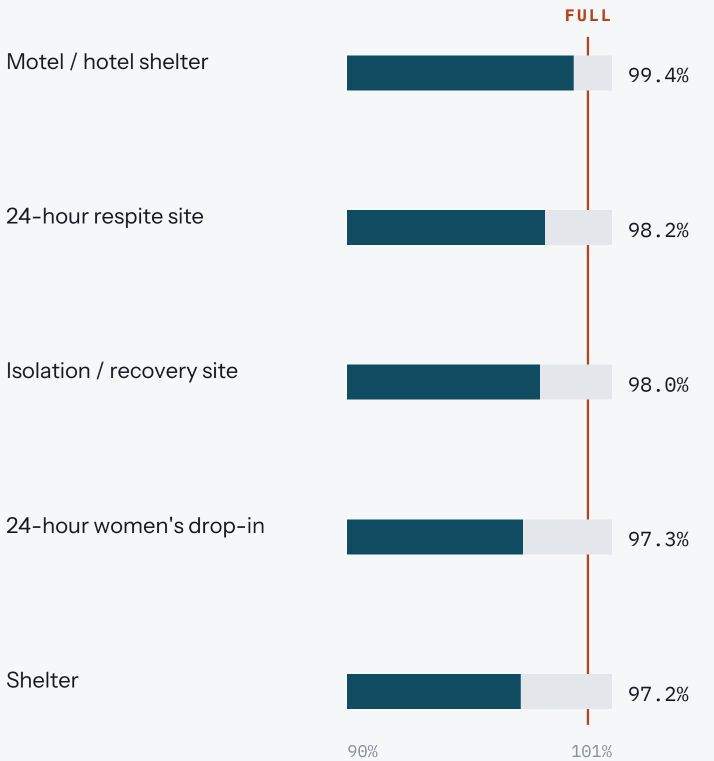
City of Toronto Open Data, Daily Shelter and Overnight Service Occupancy and Capacity. Jan 1 2024 to Dec 31 2025.
Prepared by Ryan Xian. Analysis in BigQuery SQL, report in Power BI.

Overflow space emptied out, warming centres filled up

Motel and hotel shelters stayed the fullest and steadiest service type across both years. The overflow tier behaved the opposite way: Alternative Space Protocol sites fell 25 points, which is where most of the new slack in the system shows up.

Fullest service types, two-year average

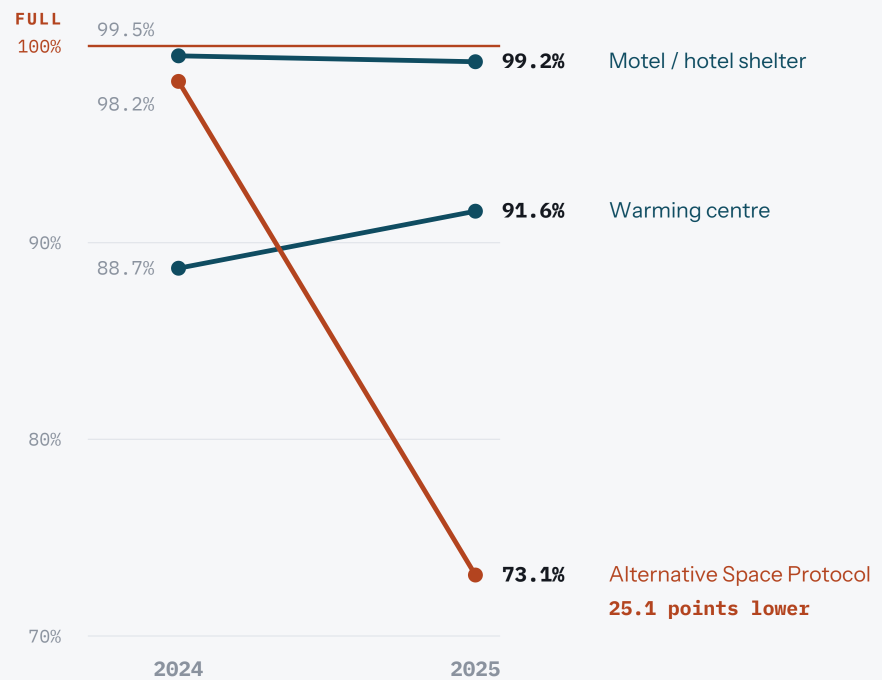
Five service types averaged 97% or higher across the period. Every one of them sits within three points of the ceiling.



Average occupancy rate across 2024 and 2025 combined, so single-year values differ. Axis zoomed to 90% to 101%.

The three service types that moved most

Warming centres were the only type that got busier. Alternative Space Protocol is overflow capacity, so a fall this size means the City stood up backup space faster than it was needed.



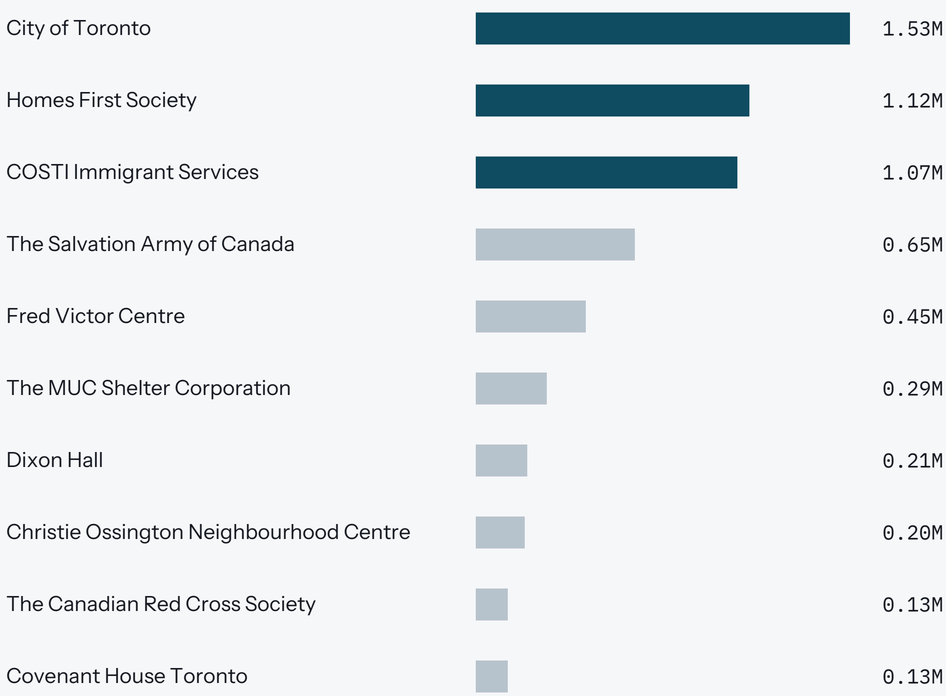
Average occupancy rate. Full scale shown rather than zoomed, because the range is wide. Alternative Space Protocol is the City's overflow tier.

Three providers carry more than half the system

The City of Toronto, Homes First Society and COSTI Immigrant Services accounted for 3.72M of 6.94M service-user days over the two years. What the system is used for barely moved, which is why the easing reads as a capacity story rather than a change in who needs shelter.

Top 10 organisations by service-user days

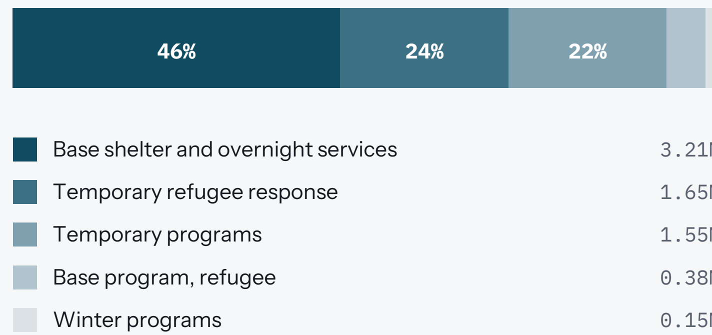
The top three carry 54% of all demand. Homes First fell the most of any large provider. COSTI, the Salvation Army and Fred Victor held steady.



Two-year total service-user days, in millions. A service-user day is one person served for one night, not one unique person. Top three shown in the darker tone.

What the system is used for

Base shelter is 46% of all demand. Refugee response, across both refugee program areas, holds close to 29% in each year and edged down from 29.5% to 28.6%. Winter programs grew from 2.1% to 2.8%.



LARGEST SINGLE PROVIDER SHIFT

638K to **485K**

Homes First Society service-user days, 2024 to 2025. A 24% fall, and the single biggest movement among the large providers.

Share of two-year service-user days. The two smallest program-area labels are read from a truncated axis in the source report and should be confirmed against the query output before circulation.

How these numbers were built

Two annual open-data extracts were combined and cleaned in BigQuery, then modelled in Power BI. Every figure in this deck traces to a query in shelter_analysis_24_25.sql.

Pipeline

1. Load. 2024 and 2025 CSVs from Toronto Open Data loaded into separate raw BigQuery tables.
2. Profile. Row counts, date coverage, null categories, duplicate program-date pairs and occupancy ranges checked before any transformation.
3. Combine. UNION ALL into one two-year table.
4. Clean. Text trimmed, missing city and program model set to Unknown, bed and room measures folded into one set of columns.
5. Model. Year, month, year-month and capacity status derived.
6. Report. Cleaned table published to Power BI.

Definitions

- Program-day. One shelter program on one night. This is the grain of every row.
- Service-user day. One person served for one night. Totals are person-nights, not unique individuals, so one person staying 30 nights counts 30 times.
- Occupancy rate. Occupied spaces divided by actual capacity. Values above 100% are real and mean a program ran over its listed capacity. They are kept, not capped.
- Capacity status. At capacity is 100% or more. Near capacity is 90% to under 100%. Available is under 90%.

Limitations

- Capacity is reported in beds by some programs and rooms by others. The two were combined into one measure so they could be compared, which means a bed and a room count as one space.
- Confidential program locations are labelled Unknown rather than dropped, so location breakdowns understate a small number of sites.
- Averages across programs are unweighted, so a 20-bed site counts the same as a 300-bed site.
- This analysis describes what changed. It does not establish why. The capacity explanation is consistent with the data but is not tested here.

WHERE EACH FIGURE COMES FROM

Page 1	System totals and KPI row	Q1	Page 2	Capacity status mix	Section 4 validation
Page 1	Monthly occupancy trend	Q4	Page 3	Occupancy by service type	Q5
Page 2	Occupancy by population sector	Q2	Page 4	Organisations by demand	Q6
Page 2	Emergency vs transitional	Q3	Page 4	Demand by program area	Q8

BigQuery project toronto-shelter-analytics24-25, dataset shelter_data. Queries: shelter_analysis_24_25.sql. Report: Power BI Desktop.

 Dataset: open.toronto.ca/dataset/daily-shelter-overnight-service-occupancy-capacity/